is inherent in the nature of national power itself. This uncertainty is, however, magnified when the weights in one or the other or in both scales are composed not only of single units but also of several nations forming alliances.

2. Unreality: The uncertainty of power calculations incapacitates the balance of power system from operating and also leads to its very negation in practice. Since nations are incapable of calculating the distribution of national power, they will at least attempt to make sure that whatever error they might commit in calculation, these will not land them in serious disadvantage in the competition of power and that they have a margin of safety.

Thus, in the struggle for power, nations actually aim not at a balance, which is equality of power, but a superiority of power in their favour. The limitless aspiration for power is always present in the mindset of nations and this transforms into an armament race which ultimately may cause war. Preventive war, however, abhorred in diplomatic language and abhorrent to democratic public opinion is, in fact, a natural outgrowth of the balance of power. The First World War is a pointer in that direction. The use of balance of power as an ideology aggravates difficulties and dangers inherent in the mechanics of the balance of power.

3. Inadequacy: Morgenthau observed that the actual contribution made by the balance of power system in the seventeenth, eighteenth and nineteenth centuries had helped in the establishment of stability of the modern state system and the preservation of the independence of its members. But it was not the balance of power system alone that helped in achieving these things; there were other factors such as the restraining influence of moral consensus present in Europe. Morgenthau also observed that the balance of power thus assumes a reality and function that it actually does not have and therefore, tends to disguise, rationalize and justify international politics as it actually is.